予 想 問 題　第 2 回

前 期 日 程　対 策

英 語 問 題

北海道大学（全学部共通）の出題形式に準拠 ／ 問題

注　意

1. 問題部分と解答用紙で構成されている（問題部分 1〜11ページ・解答用紙 12〜13ページ）。答えは解答用紙の決められた欄に書くこと。
2. 試験時間の目安は90分。大問は 1〜4 の4題。
3. 配点は 1 42点・2 42点・3 42点・4 24点（計150点）。本予想問題が独自に定めた配点である。
4. 本冊子の英文・設問はすべてオリジナルである。登場する人物・団体・地名は架空。

北海道大学の過去問・公式問題ではありません。予想問題であり，大学とは関係がありません。
本冊子は過去の出題形式を分析して作成した練習用の教材です。

1　長文読解（配点 42点）

以下の英文を読み，後の問いに答えなさい。

Few experiences are as widely disliked as boredom. We feel it in waiting rooms, on long train journeys, and during meetings that seem to have no end, and most of us will do almost anything to escape it. In the past, escape was not always possible: a person waiting for a bus had little choice but to look at the street, watch the clouds, or let the mind drift. Today, a phone in the pocket means that no moment ever needs to be empty. Whenever a gap appears in our day, we can fill it instantly with news, games, messages, or videos. It is worth asking whether this constant filling is entirely a good thing.

At first glance, the answer seems obvious. Boredom is unpleasant, and avoiding unpleasant feelings is a reasonable thing to do. (1)If technology allows us to turn wasted minutes into time spent learning, laughing, or keeping in touch with friends, it would seem foolish to refuse such an offer simply because earlier generations had to put up with long hours of dullness. Few people would argue that we should return to a world without books or radio for the sake of feeling bored more often.

Yet boredom may be more than an empty feeling waiting to be removed. It can be understood as a signal, much like hunger or tiredness, telling us that our current situation is failing to engage us. Hunger pushes us to look for food; boredom pushes us to look for something worth doing. When we respond to that signal by reaching for a phone, we silence it without asking what it was trying to tell us. (ア), we may never discover that we are dissatisfied with our work, our studies, or the way we spend our evenings, because the feeling that might have prompted change is switched off before it has a chance to grow.

Boredom is also linked with imagination. Many writers, artists, and inventors have described ideas that came to them not while they were concentrating hard, but while they were doing something dull, such as walking, washing dishes, or staring out of a window. (2)An unoccupied mind does not simply switch off; it begins to wander, to make unexpected connections, and to rehearse possibilities that a busy mind would never have time to consider. Children who are left without organized activities, for example, often complain at first, but many eventually invent games, build things, or tell themselves stories. The complaint is the beginning of the process rather than its conclusion.

Of course, not all boredom is useful. A worker performing the same task for eight hours a day, with no opportunity to vary it, may simply suffer, and no amount of daydreaming will make the job more meaningful. People who are bored for long periods, with no prospect of change, can become restless, unhappy, or even unwell. (イ) boredom can encourage reflection, it is not

something to be imposed on others or celebrated without limits. The point is not that we should seek it out, (ウ) that we should not always rush to destroy it.

What, then, can be done? One modest suggestion is to leave some gaps in the day unfilled on purpose: to walk to the station without headphones, or to sit quietly for a few minutes after finishing one task before starting the next. (3)This may feel uncomfortable at first, because we have grown used to receiving a steady stream of small rewards from our screens, and their absence can make an ordinary moment seem strangely long. With practice, however, many people find that these pauses become a source of calm, and sometimes of ideas they would not otherwise have had.

None of this requires us to give up the devices that make modern life so convenient. Phones and computers are remarkable tools, and being able to fill an idle moment with something interesting is, in many ways, a gift. But a gift that is used without thought can gradually change the person who receives it. By learning to tolerate a little boredom, we may recover a space in which the mind can wander, notice what is missing, and begin to imagine something new.

問 1　下線部(1)を和訳せよ。

問 2　(ア)を補うのにふさわしいものを，(A)〜(D)のうちから一つ選べ。

(A)　In contrast
(B)　As a result
(C)　For instance
(D)　Even so

問 3　下線部(2)はどのようなことを述べているか。本文に即して説明せよ。句読点も1字に数え，60字以内とする。

問 4　(イ)と(ウ)を補う語の組み合わせのうち，最も適当なものを(A)〜(E)から一つ選べ。

(A)　イ: Because　ウ: and
(B)　イ: Unless　ウ: or
(C)　イ: Although　ウ: but
(D)　イ: Since　ウ: so
(E)　イ: Until　ウ: nor

問 5　文頭の This が指す内容を具体的に示しつつ，下線部(3)を和訳せよ。

問 6　本文の内容と合致しないものを，(A)〜(F)のうちから二つ選べ。

(A) A phone, as the author notes, allows people to fill almost any empty moment.

(B) In the author’s view, boredom can work as a signal, much as hunger does.

(C) The author claims that boredom is always beneficial, even when it continues for years.

(D) Children without organized activities sometimes end up creating their own games.

(E) The author recommends that people stop using phones and computers altogether.

(F) Leaving some moments unfilled may feel strange at first.

2　長文読解（配点 42点）

以下の英文を読み，後の問いに答えなさい。

During my first year at university, I lived on a diet that would have worried my parents if they had known about it. I had never learned to cook, and the small kitchen in my rented room contained little more than a kettle, a microwave, and a frying pan I was slightly afraid to use. Most evenings I ate instant noodles or bread from the convenience store, telling myself that I was too busy to do anything else. In truth, I was not too busy; I simply did not know where to begin, and I was embarrassed to admit it.

My downstairs neighbor was Tomasz Wierzbicki, a retired baker in his seventies who had moved to the city from a small village decades earlier. We met on the stairs one Saturday morning when he was carrying a large paper bag of flour, and I offered to help. When we reached his door, the smell of warm bread drifted out so strongly that I must have looked hungry, because he laughed and invited me in. (1)Within ten minutes I was sitting at his kitchen table with a thick slice of bread in my hand, listening to him explain why the loaf in front of me had taken almost two days to make.

Before I left, he asked whether I baked. I admitted that I could barely boil an egg. He looked at me for a moment and then said, quite seriously, that anyone who could follow a set of instructions and wait patiently could learn to make bread. (　ア　), he suggested that I come back the following Saturday. I agreed mostly out of politeness, expecting that he would forget. He did not. At nine o’clock the next week, he knocked on my door with an apron folded over his arm.

Those Saturday mornings became the most reliable part of my week. Tomasz was a demanding teacher. He insisted that I weigh every ingredient rather than guess, and he made me knead the dough until my arms ached. When I asked whether a machine could do the work, he shrugged and said that a machine could, but that I would then learn nothing about how dough should feel. (2)My first loaves were heavy, flat, and occasionally burnt, but he never threw one away; instead, he cut each one open and showed me what it could tell us about what had gone wrong. A dense center meant the dough had not risen long enough; large holes near the crust meant the oven had been too hot. Failure, in his kitchen, was not a disappointment but a kind of evidence.

What surprised me most was how much of baking consisted of waiting. After mixing and kneading, there was nothing to do for an hour or more except let the dough rise. At first, I found this frustrating and kept lifting the cloth to check on it. Tomasz told me that dough, like people, does not improve by being watched constantly. During those pauses, he made coffee and told me about the village bakery where he had started work at fourteen, about the customers who came

every morning before dawn, and about the years when flour was scarce and bread had to be made to last. Gradually I realized that the waiting was not empty time at all. It was when most of the real conversation happened.

When the academic year drew to a close, I could make a respectable loaf on my own, and I had also started cooking simple meals, since the confidence I had gained in Tomasz's kitchen seemed to spread to everything else. More importantly, I no longer felt like a stranger in the building. When Tomasz caught a bad cold in the spring and could not leave his apartment for a week, it was my turn to knock on his door. I brought him a loaf I had made the night before. (3)He examined it with the same critical eye he had always used, pressed the crust with his thumb, and finally announced that it would do. Coming from him, that was the highest praise imaginable.

I often think about why those lessons mattered so much to me. Part of the answer is practical: I learned a skill that I still use almost every week. But the deeper reason is that Tomasz treated my ignorance not as something shameful but as a starting point. (4)He seemed to understand that the hardest step for a beginner is not learning the technique but daring to try in front of someone else. I now live in another city, and I bake for my own neighbors when I can. Whenever someone tells me they could never learn, I remember the apron folded over his arm and offer to show them.

問 1　下線部(1)を和訳せよ。

問 2　(ア)を補うのにふさわしいものを，(A)〜(D)のうちから一つ選べ。

(A) To prove his point
(B) Instead of helping me
(C) In spite of his advice
(D) Having forgotten my name

問 3　下線部(2)の言わんとすることに最も近いものを，(A)〜(D)のうちから一つ選べ。

(A) Tomasz ate the author's bread so that it would not be wasted.
(B) Tomasz thought the author's bread was too heavy to sell.
(C) Tomasz blamed the oven rather than the author for the failures.
(D) Tomasz used each failed loaf as a way of teaching the author.

問 4　第5段落から，筆者がパン生地を待つ時間を当初どのように感じていたかを表す1語を抜き出して英語で記せ。

問 5　下線部(3)の発言が筆者にとって最高の褒め言葉であったのはなぜか。句読点も1字に数え，40字以内で説明せよ。

問 6　下線部(4)を和訳せよ。

問 7　本文の趣旨に合致する英文を，(A)〜(F)のうちから二つ選べ。

(A) The author ate convenience-store food because he was genuinely too busy to cook.

(B) Tomasz believed that patience was one of the things needed to learn baking.

(C) Tomasz encouraged the author to use a machine to save time when kneading.

(D) The time spent waiting for the dough gave Tomasz and the author a chance to talk.

(E) The author stopped baking after moving to another city.

(F) Tomasz had worked in a large factory before opening his own bakery.

3　英文読解・英語での解答（配点 42点）

Read the passage below.

For more than a century, public libraries in many countries have charged small fines when borrowers return books late. The idea seemed simple: a penalty would encourage people to bring materials back on time, so that others could use them. In recent years, however, more and more libraries have decided to abolish these fines altogether, and the decision has provoked lively debate among librarians, local politicians, and readers.

Supporters of the change argue that fines do more harm than good. The amounts involved are usually small, but for families with limited income, even a modest debt can become a reason to stop visiting the library. Some children, after losing or damaging a single book, are banned from borrowing until the charge is paid, and they may never come back. Librarians have also pointed out that collecting fines takes up staff time that could be spent helping visitors find information or organizing reading programs. In some cases, the cost of processing small payments is almost as high as the money collected.

Libraries that have removed fines often report encouraging results. Many say that former members have returned, and that the number of books brought back has not fallen; in some places it has even risen, because people who were embarrassed about overdue items no longer avoid the building. Instead of charging money, these libraries send friendly reminders and, if an item is kept for a very long time, ask the borrower to replace it.

Critics, however, worry that removing penalties sends the wrong message. They argue that returning borrowed property on time is a basic responsibility, and that without any consequence, some people will keep popular books for months while others wait. Some also fear that the lost income, though small, will make it harder for libraries to buy new materials.

The debate reflects a deeper question about what libraries are for. If they are mainly lenders of property, fines may seem a fair way to protect shared resources. If they are places meant to welcome everyone, especially those with few other sources of books and information, then anything that keeps people away may be too high a price to pay.

Respond to Questions A–C in English. Ideas and vocabulary from the passage may be used, but whole sentences should not be reproduced.

Question A

Fill in the blanks to finish the sentence below.

The second paragraph suggests that supporters of the change believe fines can discourage _____ and that collecting them uses up _____ .

Question B

Fill in the blanks to finish the sentence below.

The fourth paragraph shows that critics are concerned that, without fines, _____ , and that libraries may have less money to _____ .

Question C

It is often argued that public facilities such as libraries, museums, and sports centers should be free for everyone and paid for entirely by taxes. Do you agree? Give your view and the reasons for it, using between 70 and 100 words.

4　会話文と要約文（配点 24点）

Read the conversation [I] between two university students, Nanami and Riku, which ends with a phone call to their classmate Kenta, and then the summary of it [II]. The summary has 12 blanks. Fill each blank with the most suitable word from the box; no word may be used more than once. Mark your answers by giving the letter of each chosen word.

[I : Conversation]

Nanami: Riku, have you heard anything from Kenta? Our presentation for the economics seminar is next Thursday, and he still hasn't sent me his part of the slides.

Riku: Not a word since our meeting last week. I sent him a message on Monday asking how his research on local shopping streets was going, but he hasn't even read it.

Nanami: That's strange. At the first meeting he seemed so enthusiastic, and the topic was his idea to begin with.

Riku: I know. Honestly, I'm starting to get a little exasperated. I've already finished the section on population change, and you've almost completed the interviews with shop owners.

Nanami: I have, but I can't write the conclusion until I know what he's found. His part is supposed to connect our two sections, so everything depends on it.

Riku: Should we just tell Professor Hayashi? She said at the beginning of term that we should report any problems with group work as early as possible.

Nanami: Maybe, but I'd rather not go to her straight away. It might make Kenta feel as if we're trying to get him into trouble, and we still have to work with him until the semester ends.

Riku: That's a valid concern. But we can't simply wait and hope he turns up on Thursday with everything ready.

Nanami: No, we can't. What if we call him instead of sending another message? Texts are easy to overlook, but it's much harder to avoid a phone call from friends.

Riku: Good point. Actually, I remember he mentioned a few weeks ago that his grandmother had been taken to hospital. Maybe something serious has happened at home.

Nanami: Oh, I didn't know that. If so, we should be more understanding. He might be too worried, or too embarrassed, to tell us he's fallen behind.

Riku: Exactly. Let's offer to help rather than grumble. If he gives us his notes, we could turn them into slides ourselves.

Nanami: That would mean extra work for us, though, and the deadline is already close. I'm a bit wary that we'd be encouraging him to rely on others instead of doing his share.

Riku: I see your point. But the presentation counts for thirty percent of our final mark, and that applies to all three of us, not just Kenta.

Nanami: True. Perhaps we could divide his part into more manageable tasks, so that he only has to handle the analysis while we take care of the design.

Riku:

That sounds like a sensible compromise. And if he still hasn't replied by Saturday, then we'll explain the situation to Professor Hayashi. At least we'll know we tried.

Nanami: Agreed. Should I call him now? I've got about fifteen minutes before my next lecture starts.

Riku: Go ahead. Put it on speaker so that I can take part as well.

Kenta: Hello? Nanami? I'm so sorry. I've been meaning to get back to you both all week, but I kept procrastinating.

Nanami: Don't worry about that. We just wanted to check that you're all right. Riku's here with me too.

Kenta: Thanks. My grandmother underwent surgery, and I've been visiting the hospital almost every day. I've collected most of the data, but I haven't had time to analyze it, and I felt terrible about letting you both down.

Riku: You haven't let us down at all. Send us whatever you have, and we'll split the remaining work between us. You can concentrate on the analysis whenever you find time.

Kenta: That's incredibly considerate of you. I'll send everything tonight, and I promise I'll finish the analysis by Sunday evening.

[II : Summary]

Nanami and Riku are (1) because Kenta, the third member of their group, has not yet sent his part of a presentation that is due next Thursday. Riku says that Kenta has not even opened the message he sent on Monday. Nanami finds this puzzling, since Kenta had seemed extremely (2) at their first meeting and had proposed the topic himself. Both of them have already put a considerable amount of effort into the project, so the delay is particularly frustrating.

Riku admits that he is becoming (3), as he has already completed his own section. Nanami explains that she cannot write the conclusion, because Kenta's section is meant to (4) the other two parts. Riku suggests reporting the problem to Professor Hayashi, who had asked students to do so early. Nanami, however, prefers not to (5) to the professor immediately, because Kenta might feel that his partners want to get him into trouble.

Nanami proposes telephoning Kenta, since a call is harder to (6) than a text message. Riku also suggests that, if Kenta hands over his notes, Nanami and he could turn the notes into slides on Kenta's behalf. Riku then recalls that Kenta's grandmother had been admitted to hospital, and both agree that they should be more (7) toward him. Although Nanami worries that doing extra work might (8) Kenta for neglecting his share, Riku reminds her that the presentation affects the (9) of all three members.

They decide to divide Kenta's part into smaller tasks and to inform the professor only if he fails to (10) by Saturday. When Nanami calls him, Kenta apologizes and explains that he has been visiting his grandmother, who has undergone an operation. He says he feels (11) about disappointing them. Riku reassures him that he and Nanami will share the remaining tasks, so

that Kenta can focus on the analysis whenever he has time, and Kenta promises to send his data that evening and to (12) the analysis by Sunday.

(A) absent	(B) borrow	(C) careless
(D) complain	(E) complete	(F) doubt
(G) eager	(H) fortunately	(J) grades
(K) guilty	(L) hesitate	(M) ignore
(N) irritated	(P) link	(Q) praise
(R) respond	(S) reward	(T) salary
(U) sympathetic	(V) weekly	(W) worried

注）記号 (I) と (O) は数字と紛らわしいため使っていない。

解答用紙　予想問題 第2回

受験番号・氏名欄は省略。記号は (A) のように書く。

1

問 1

問 2　［　　］

問 3

60字（20字×3行，10字ごとに太線）

問 4　［　　］

問 5

問 6　［　　］［　　］

2

問 1

問 2　［　　］

問 3　［　　］

問 4　［　　］

問 5

40字（20字×2行，10字ごとに太線）

問 6

問 7　［　　］［　　］

解答用紙（3・4）

3　Question A

3　Question B

3　Question C（70〜100語）

20語

40語

60語

80語

100語

4

(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)

奥付

予想問題 第2回　英語　問題

対象：北海道大学 前期日程 英語（全学部共通）の受験準備

作成：学習アプリ マナトビ 編集部（2026年10月）

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> **北海道大学の過去問・公式問題ではありません。予想問題であり，大学とは関係がありません。**

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